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MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU – BBA (HONOURS) REGULAR EXAMINATION OCTOBER 2025

THIRD SEMESTER

CORE COURSE – MG3CCRBBA200 – HUMAN RESOURCE MANAGEMENT

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

DURATION – 2Hrs MAXIMUM MARKS -70

Remember (K), Understand (U), Apply(A), Analyse(An), Evaluate (E), Create (C), Skill (S), Interest(I) nd Appreciation(Ap)

PART A (3marks)

Short Answer Questions (four to five sentences)

A choice between two options for each question, answer five short answer questions, one from each pair

1 a. Describe the features of HRM? [K] CO1

1. The focal point of HRM is people. It strongly believes that all other resources are meaningless devoid of people because they only have the capacity to generate value.
2. HRM integrates HR policies with business planning
3. The responsibility of HR Management is vested in the senior line management
4. It focuses on employer – employee relations instead of employer – trade union relations
5. HRM emphasis on the commitment and initiative of management for enabling and empowering the workforce for best quality performance

1 b. Describe the role difference between a personnel manager and an HR manager [A]CO1

Aspect	Personnel Manager	HR manager
Nature of role	Traditional and reactive	Modern and proactive
Primary Functions	Recruitment, payroll, employee records, compliance	Talent management, performance, training, culture, strategy
Focus	Employee administration and maintenance	Employee development and organizational strategy
Scope of Work	Focuses on employee welfare, attendance, discipline	Covers leadership development, succession planning, engagement, culture building

Linkage to organisational strategies	Low	High

(any 3 points or other relevant points can be considered)

2 a. Analyse the key aspects of managing the virtual teams [An] CO2

A virtual HR team consists of HR professionals who collaborate through digital platforms rather than working in the same physical location. They handle various HR functions such as recruitment, training, performance management, and employee engagement through tools like Zoom, Microsoft Teams and HR Information Systems (HRIS).

The main aspects of managing the virtual teams are:

1.Effective communication is important in any team, but it presents big challenges in virtual meetings. Proactive communication strategies, including regular meetings, instant messaging systems and project management tools are essential in virtual work settings

2.Detailed job descriptions outlining individual roles, responsibilities and performance are highly essential for effective management of virtual teams

3.Establish a clear reporting structure and ensure each team member understands their contribution to the overall goals.

4.regular performance reviews are essential for effective management of virtual teams

5. Provide constructive feedback promptly and offer support to help employees in order to overcome challenges

(any 3 points)

2 b. Give the alternatives to recruitment [U] /CO1,CO2,CO3,CO4

Alternatives to recruitment methods are used by organisations to meet staffing needs without hiring new employees from outside. These alternatives are often used to save costs, manage workforce flexibility, or respond to short-term changes in workload. Alternatives to recruitment are overtime, temporary or contract workers, internal transfers and promotions, job redesign, training and development, outsourcing etc

3 a. Explain Job Specification [U]/CO1,CO2,CO3,CO4

Job specification is derived from job analysis. It is a written statement of the qualifications and abilities required to enable the job to be performed satisfactorily. The main content of job specification includes requirement concerning education level, experience, specific competencies and personal characteristics.

3 b. Who are gig employees? Mention two key challenges in managing them. [U]/ CO2

Gig employees (also called freelancers, independent contractors, or on-demand workers) are individuals who work on a temporary, project-based, or freelance basis rather than being employed full-time by a single organization. These workers are paid per task or project instead of receiving a regular salary and usually do not receive traditional employee benefits such as health insurance, paid leave, or pensions.

Key challenges in managing gig employees are

1. Lack of Commitment and Engagement
2. Legal and Compliance Issues
3. Communication and Coordination
4. Performance monitoring and quality control
5. Data security and confidentiality
6. Integration with organisational culture
7. Managing availability and reliability

4 a. Examine how 360 Degree feedback provides more holistic view compared to the Graphic rating scale. [A]/ CO3

Graphic rating scale : It is a traditional performance appraisal tool where a supervisor rates an employee on various performance factors such as punctuality, teamwork, initiative, or quality of work. Ratings are typically done on a numerical or descriptive scale (e.g., 1–5 or "Poor" to "Excellent"). Evaluation is one-dimensional, usually conducted by the immediate supervisor.

360 Degree feedback – It is a multi-source appraisal method where feedback is collected from multiple stakeholders including supervisors, peers, subordinates, and sometimes customers — along with self-assessment. It provides a comprehensive view of an employee's performance and behaviour across various interactions and relationships.

360 degree is more holistic because

1.it captures diverse perspectives on behaviour and performance.
2.It reflects how the employee is perceived at all levels of the organization
3.It identifies key development areas for the individual, a department and the organisation as a whole.
4. It facilitates for continuous improvement
5. It provides contextual feedback for personal development.

(any 3 points)

4 b. Discuss the impact of offering fringe benefits on employee motivation and productivity [An] / CO3

Fringe benefits are additional benefits that are provided by the organisations to its employees in addition to wage or salary.

Impact of offering fringe benefits on employee motivation are

Increases Job Satisfaction
Enhances Employee Loyalty and Commitment
Boosts Morale and Engagement
Satisfies Higher-Level Needs
Impact of offering fringe benefits on productivity are
Reduces Absenteeism and Fatigue
Attracts and retains competent people
Encourages Higher Performance
Promotes Work-Life Balance

*(any 3 points with explanation)

5 a. Mention two ways HR can promote employee well- being at the workplace [U] / CO4

Health and Wellness Programs- Regular health check-ups, vaccination drives, fitness programs, and mental health counseling.
Work-Life Balance Initiatives - Flexible working hours, remote work options, paid leave, and parental support.
Safe and Ergonomic Work Environment - Ensuring workplace safety, proper lighting, ergonomic furniture, and safety training.
Training and career development - Offering skill development, leadership programs, and career advancement opportunities.
Recognition and Reward Systems - Acknowledging achievements through awards, bonuses, or appreciation programs

(any 2 ways)

5 b. How can the reporting and analytics feature of an HRIS help HR managers in strategic decision-making [A] / CO4

HRIS provides powerful reporting and analytics capabilities. This allows HR manger to obtain key information, identify trends, and gain valuable insights into workforce data, performance appraisal and other relevant information. Data driven insights help organisations to make informed decisions about workforce planning, compensation strategies, training initiatives, and other strategic HR initiatives. These initiatives also contribute to a strong understanding of organisational effectiveness.

PART B
SHORT ESSAY (5Marks)

6 a. Hiring the right person is just the beginning of a longer HR journey. Analyse how HRM ensures continuous employee development post hiring [U]/ CO1

Once the right person is brought on board, HRM must focus on continuous employee development to sustain performance, engagement, and retention. HRM ensures continuous employee development through the following ways:

1.Orientation: After hiring, HRM ensures that new employees integrate smoothly into the organisation through Induction programmes that familiarize employees with company culture, policies, and expectations etc. Orientation is necessary to reduce stress and anxiety among new staff.

2. Training and Development Programmes: Training is a learning process that implies gaining of new knowledge, sharpening of skills, understanding concepts, rules, or changing of attitudes and behaviour to improve the performance of people.

HRM promotes lifelong learning through structured programs such as:

Technical and soft skills training (e.g., communication, leadership, problem-solving).
E-learning platforms that encourage self-paced learning.
Workshops and seminars to keep employees updated with industry changes.

3. Performance Management and Feedback

Continuous development requires regular assessment and feedback:

Performance appraisals identify strengths and areas for improvement.
Continuous feedback systems (rather than annual reviews) help employees correct course in real time.
Goal setting (SMART goals) ensures employees have clear developmental objectives.

4. Career Development and Succession Planning

HRM provides opportunities for employees to advance within the organisation:
Career paths and progression frameworks give clarity on advancement opportunities.
Job rotation, enrichment, and enlargement expose employees to varied experiences.
Succession planning identifies and develops future leaders.

5. Coaching and Mentoring

Mentorship programmes connect junior staff with experienced professionals for guidance.
Executive coaching helps leaders refine management and interpersonal skills.

6. Employee Engagement and Wellbeing Initiatives

HRM supports holistic development through:

Work-life balance policies (flexible schedules, wellness programmes).
Recognition and reward systems to motivate performance.
Employee surveys to gather feedback and adjust development initiatives.

Post-hiring, HRM plays a strategic role in ensuring continuous employee development through structured learning, performance management, and supportive culture-building. The result is not only enhanced employee capability and satisfaction but also improved organisational effectiveness and adaptability.

(any 5 points or other relevant points may be considered)

6 b. Describe any 5 emerging trends in HRM [U]/CO1

Emerging trends in HRM are

1.Globalisation: Growing internationalisation of business has a significant impact on HRM.The functions of hiring, training, compensation, maintenance and so on acquire global perspective. HR department is required to cope with problems of unfamiliar languages, laws, managerial styles, work ethics etc.
2.Talent acquisition and retention: attracting and retaining top talent in a competitive global market is a major problem. Competition for skilled workers is intense which requires HRM to develop creative recruitment strategies and competitive compensation packages.
3.Cultural differences and communication: Managing a diverse workforce across multiple countries and cultures requires exceptional cross cultural communication skills. HRM must develop strategies to bridge communication gaps, foster inclusivity and ensure effective collaboration across different teams and locations
4.Legal and regulatory compliances: Managing the complexity of international labour laws and regulations is a significant challenge. HRM must ensure compliance with various employment laws, tax laws in each operating country, which often differs significantly. Failing to comply can result in heavy finesand reputational damage,
5.Manage remote and virtual teams: The rise of remote work and online workforce presents unique HRM challenges. Maintaining effective communication, collaboration and performance management in a geographically dispersed workforce requires innovative tools and strategies. Building trust and fostering a sense of team relation in a virtual environment requires careful planning and constant effort.
6. Corporate restructuring: Reorganisations resulting from acquisitions, merger and divestiture have a significant bearing on organisational levels. Employees face anxiety and uncertainty about their places.
7.Changing workforce: The percentage of women and minorities in workforce is increasing. Steady increase in the number of white-collar employees and increasing education level are other demographic changes in workforce.
8.Growing Employee Expectations: Employee expectations and attitudes are changing. Traditional inducements such as job security, compensation, housing and the like do not attract and motivate today's workforce.

(any 5 points)

7 a. Analyse the impact of an ineffective performance appraisal system on employee morale and organisational productivity [An] CO3

Performance appraisal is the periodical, formal evaluation of employee performance for making career decisions. The absence of a reliable performance appraisal system will deteriorate the whole process of HRM, resulting in the total waste of the valuable human assets owned by the company. When implemented effectively, it motivates employees, aligns individual goals with organisational objectives, and enhances productivity. However, an ineffective appraisal system one that is biased, inconsistent, or poorly

communicated can have serious negative consequences on both employee morale and organisational productivity.

The impact of an ineffective performance appraisal system on employee morale and organisational productivity are as follows:

- Reduced Job Satisfaction and Engagement- An ineffective appraisal system often fails to provide constructive feedback or clear guidance for improvement. Employees may not understand what is expected of them or how they can grow within the organization, leading to frustration and disengagement.
- Loss of Motivation and Engagement - If employees perceive the appraisal process as unfair or inaccurate, they lose motivation to perform well. When high performers receive the same ratings as low performers, it discourages effort and fosters complacency.
- Decline in Employee Retention - Talented employees are more likely to leave when they feel their contributions are not recognised or fairly evaluated. This will lead to high turnover rates and loss of organisational knowledge.
- Perception of Bias and Favouritism - Subjective or poorly designed appraisal systems often reflect personal bias rather than objective performance. Employees may feel undervalued or discriminated against, leading to frustration, mistrust, and decreased job satisfaction.
- Increased Stress and Anxiety - When appraisals focus solely on criticism without constructive feedback, employees experience anxiety and job insecurity. This will lead to Reduced confidence, increased absenteeism, and potential burnout etc

An ineffective performance appraisal system can severely damage employee morale and reduce organisational productivity. To prevent this, HRM must ensure objectivity, transparency, regular feedback, and developmental focus in the appraisal process. A fair and constructive system transforms appraisals from a formality into a strategic tool for motivation and growth.

(Any 5 points or other relevant points may be considered)

7 b) Evaluate how basic salary and wages affect employee retention and turnover rates in organisations, which system contribute more positively to employee loyalty? [E] CO3

Compensation is one of the strongest determinants of employee satisfaction and retention. Basic salary and wages serve as the foundation of an employee's financial security and perception of fairness. When managed effectively, they enhance loyalty, reduce turnover, and strengthen organisational commitment. However, if poorly structured, they can lead to dissatisfaction and high attrition rates.

Impact of Basic Salary on Employee Retention are (1.5marks)

a) Stability and Predictability

A **basic salary** provides employees with a consistent, predictable income. Financial stability allows employees to focus on their work rather than personal financial stress. Result will be increased job satisfaction and long-term commitment.

b) Perception of Fairness and Value

Employees view a fair salary as recognition of their contribution. This Enhances morale, motivation, and the psychological contract between employer and employee. This will reduce **the likelihood of seeking alternative employment.**

c) Career Growth and Internal Equity

When basic salary structures reflect seniority, experience, and performance, employees perceive growth opportunities within the organisation.

Impact of Wages on Retention and Turnover are (1.5marks)

a) Flexibility and Short-Term Motivation

Wages (often hourly or performance-based pay) can motivate short-term effort, particularly in blue-collar or temporary jobs. This may encourage productivity but may not guarantee long-term attachment.

b. Income Insecurity

Hourly or variable wage systems can create uncertainty when work hours fluctuate. Employees may leave for more stable, salaried roles, increasing turnover rates.

c. Limited Career Attachment

Wage-based roles often lack progression frameworks, reducing employees' sense of belonging. Impact will be higher turnover, especially if better-paying options are available elsewhere.

Evaluation: (2marks)

The basic salary system contributes more positively to employee loyalty and retention because it offers financial stability, fairness, and a sense of belonging. In contrast, a wage system may drive performance in the short term but fails to foster long-term commitment, especially where workers seek job security and career growth.

8 a) Imagine you are an HR manager in a retail chain. How would you design a training programme to improve emotional intelligence among frontline staff? [A] CO4

** As an HR manager in a retail chain, design of a training programme would be to develop emotional intelligence (EI) among frontline staff to improve customer service, teamwork, and job satisfaction.

The first step would be to conduct a training needs analysis through employee feedback and customer service reports to identify emotional or behavioural gaps. The programme's key

objectives would be to enhance self-awareness, self-regulation, motivation, empathy, and social skills—the five core elements of EI.

The training would include interactive workshops, role plays, and case studies that simulate real customer interactions. Activities would focus on recognising emotions, managing stress, showing empathy towards customers, and communicating effectively with colleagues.

To reinforce learning, short follow-up sessions and coaching would be conducted monthly. Evaluation would be based on improvements in customer satisfaction, peer feedback, and observed behavioural changes.

Overall, this EI training programme would help staff handle customers more effectively, build stronger team relationships, and create a positive retail environment that enhances both employee morale and organisational performance.

** *students have the flexibility to design the training programme in any format or structure they prefer when responding to this question. The emphasis should be on their understanding of training design principles—including needs assessment, objectives, content, methods, implementation, and evaluation—rather than on adherence to a specific format*.

8 b) Develop an HR strategy for an SME facing high employee attrition [E]/ CO4

For a Small and Medium Enterprise (SME) facing high employee attrition, a well-structured HR strategy should focus on improving retention, engagement, and organisational culture.

First, the HR department should conduct an exit and engagement analysis to identify key reasons for employee turnover, such as low pay, poor career growth, or weak management practices. Based on these findings, the strategy would include:

1. Competitive Compensation: Review salary and benefits to ensure fairness and alignment with industry standards.
2. Career Development: Introduce training programmes, mentorship, and clear career paths to promote employee growth.
3. Employee Engagement: Build a positive work culture through recognition schemes, team-building activities, and open communication.
4. Work–Life Balance: Offer flexible working hours or wellness initiatives to reduce stress and burnout.
5. Effective Recruitment and selection: Hire employees who fit the organisation's culture and provide strong induction support to improve retention.

Overall, this HR strategy would enhance job satisfaction, strengthen commitment, and significantly reduce attrition within the SME.

(any 5 points or other relevant points may be considered)

PART C (20marks)

LONG ESSAY

9 a) Narrate the HR Information System, its uses in HR Planning [U]/ CO1,CO2,CO3,CO4

(10 marks)

HRIS is the application of Information Technology in the preparation and maintenance of HR data. A HRIS is a software solution for organisations to automate HR management. HRIS includes employees name, qualifications, date of birth, department, job title, date of joining, grade, salary, training completed and all the relevant data of the workforce. HRIS is typically a database system that allows a company to track of all types of information related to HR.

HRIS combines in one system all the information that organisations typically keep on workforce and positions. It can be formed by combing all HR data of an organisation in to one database.

The effectiveness of HRP depends on the effectiveness of HRIS in that organisation because HRP process work on the HR information supplied by the organisation. Past and present information are necessary to predict future HR requirements.

Uses of HRIS in Human Resource Planning (HRP) (10marks)

A Human Resource Information System (HRIS) is a technology-based system that collects, stores, and processes HR data to support strategic and operational HR functions. In the context of Human Resource Planning (HRP), HRIS is indispensable for ensuring that the organisation has the right number of employees with the right skills at the right time. The uses can be as follows:

a) Workforce Data Management

b) Forecasting and demand supply analysis

c) Recruitment and staffing planning

d) Succession and career planning

e) Training and development planning

f) Performance management and decision support

e) Cost and budgeting control

f) Enhancing HR efficiency and accuracy

HRIS is a strategic tool for HRP, helping organisations forecast workforce needs, plan recruitment and training, support succession, and make informed, cost-effective decisions. By integrating data and analytics, HRIS ensures the right talent is available at the right time, enhancing organisational efficiency and competitiveness.

9 b) Prepare a comprehensive training and development strategy for a retail chain facing poor customer service ratings. Include objectives, methods, types of training and expected outcomes. [A] CO2

Training and development strategy (5marks)

1.Training need assessment

2.Core training modules

3. Training methods

4.Evaluation and Monitoring

5.Recognition and motivation

6.Expected outcomes

Objectives of Training (5marks)

1. To impart new skills and knowledge to the workforce for improving their performance
2. To create awareness about judicious use of organisational resources
3. To teach employees to effectively operate, repair and maintain machinery and other equipment in the organisation
4. To create awareness among the people about health and safety standards
5. To familiarise employees with new technology, concepts and practices for effectively discharging their duties

Methods of Training (5marks)

1. On the job training
2. Off the job training
3. Job instruction training
4. Vestibule training
5. Apprenticeship training
6. Classroom training
7. Internship training
8. E-Learning

Types of training (5marks)

1.Orientation training
2.Job training
3.Safety training
4.Promotional training
5.Refresher training
6. Remedial training

PART D

COMPULSORY CASE STUDY (20marks)

10 a

1.Narrate the case with suitable Title for the case. Justify your title

***Title - *"The Hidden Inequality Behind Employee Equality*"* (2marks)

Narration: (5marks)
Watson Public Limited Company, known for its fair treatment of employees and strong employee–management relations, faced sudden issues in quality, mismatch in packing materials, incorrect labelling of material, not despatching the material on time etc. Despite a strong culture of equality symbolized through identical uniforms and shared benefits, discontent started to grow.

Upon investigation, it was found that the company had hired new employees for higher-level posts without considering internal candidates. These new recruits were also offered higher pay packages compared to existing employees in the same cadre. This created dissatisfaction, lowered morale, and resulted in negligence and errors in work.

Justification of the Title: (3marks)
The title "The Hidden Inequality Behind Employee Equality" reflects how the company's visible equality was contradicted by unfair internal practices like unequal pay and overlooked promotions. Though the company preached equality, hidden disparities damaged employee motivation and organisational harmony.

2.Help the organisation to come out from this critical issue. If you are in the role of HR Manager what will be your immediate step to solve this case.

Immediate Steps as HR Manager: (10marks)

<u>Conduct an Employee Satisfaction Survey:</u>
Collect honest feedback to understand the extent of dissatisfaction and specific grievances among existing employees.

<u>Review Compensation and Promotion Policies:</u>
Ensure pay parity and transparent promotion criteria. Internal employees with experience and performance should get fair consideration for promotions before hiring externally.

<u>Communicate Transparently:</u>
Arrange an open meeting to explain the reasons behind external recruitment and assure employees that fairness will be restored through structured HR policies.

<u>Develop an Internal Career Growth Plan:</u>
Introduce a system of *internal job postings* and *skill development programs* so that deserving employees can grow within the company.

Recognition and Reward Programmes:
Reinforce motivation by recognizing the contributions of long-term employees through performance-based incentives and awards.

Long-Term HR Strategy:
Build a balanced compensation structure and establish clear career paths, ensuring both fairness and competitiveness in the job market.

***Each student is free to propose title for the case study and take immediate steps to solve the case.*

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